

**THIS REQUEST FOR INFORMATION (RFI) – SOURCES SOUGHT IS ISSUED SOLELY FOR MARKET
RESEARCH AND PLANNING PURPOSES ONLY AND
DOES NOT CONSTITUTE A SOLICITATION**

**THE SUBMISSION OF PRICING, CAPABILITIES FOR PLANNING PURPOSES, AND OTHER MARKET
INFORMATION IS HIGHLY ENCOURAGED AND ALLOWED UNDER THIS RFI IN ACCORDANCE WITH (IAW)
FAR 15.201(e).**

DISCLAIMER

This RFI is issued solely for information and planning purposes only and does not constitute a solicitation. All information received in response to this RFI that is marked as proprietary will be handled accordingly. IAW FAR 15.201(e), responses to this notice are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government to form a binding contract. Responders are solely responsible for all expenses associated with responding to this RFI.

THE NAICS FOR THIS REQUIREMENT IS

325413 - In-Vitro Diagnostic Substance Manufacturing (size standard of 1,250 employs).

SOURCES SOUGHT/RFI DESCRIPTION

This is NOT a solicitation announcement. Responses to this Sources Sought must be in writing. The purpose of this Sources Sought Announcement is for market research only to make appropriate acquisition decisions and to gain knowledge of Small Businesses, including Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Businesses and Veteran-Owned Small Businesses (SDVOSB/VOSB), who are interested in submitting proposals for this procurement and who are capable of performing the work required for this procurement. Responses to this Sources Sought RFI will be used by the Government to make appropriate acquisition decisions. After review of the responses to this Sources Sought RFI, a solicitation announcement may be published. Responses to this Sources Sought RFI synopsis are not considered adequate responses for a solicitation announcement.

The Department of Veterans Affairs (VA), VISN 22 Long Beach Network Contracting Office, is seeking sources who can provide reagents and consumables that shall be delivered to participating Veterans Integrated Service Network 22 (hereafter as VISN 22), Pathology and Laboratory Medicine Services (hereafter as PALMS) Healthcare System and Medical Center. The reagents and consumables shall be Food & Drug Administration approved (FDA), American Association of Blood Bank (hereafter as AABB) accredited, College of American Pathologist (hereafter as CAP) accredited and have been validated by VISN 22 PALMS.

BRAND NAME AND EQUAL TO PRODUCT INFORMATION:

1. See **Attachment A** for brand name, make and part number information. Fill out Attachment A as appropriate.
 - Fill in **Columns I, K, M, O, and Q** in **Attachment A** of the attached Excel Spreadsheet. Do not enter data into other cells.
 - If providing a different brand that meets the requirements without modification also fill in columns **E, F and G**
2. See **RFI Attachment B SOW** for Statement of Work details.

The information identified above and in **Attachments A & B** are intended to be descriptive, not restrictive and to indicate the quality of the supplies/services that will be satisfactory. It is the responsibility of the interested source to demonstrate to the government that the interested parties can provide the supplies/services that fulfill the required specifications.

PERFORMANCE WORK STATEMENT: IF APPLICABLE

See RFI Attachment B SOW

INTERESTED AND CAPABLE CONTRACTORS

If you are interested and capable of providing the sought-out supplies/services, you are encouraged to respond to this notice via email to Marcos.Diaz@va.gov.

- Telephone responses will not be accepted.
- Responses must be received no later than Wednesday, May 20, by 07:00 A.M. PST.
- Ensure to include the following in subject line of your email submission:
RFI: 36C26226Q0599

If you are interested and are capable of providing the sought-out supplies/services, please provide the requested information as well as the information indicated below. Response to this notice should include company name, address, point of contact, size of business pursuant to the following questions:

- (1) Please indicate the size status and representations of your business, such as but not limited to: Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business (SDVOSB), Veteran Owned Small Business (VOSB), Hubzone, Woman Owned Small Business (WOSB), Large Business, etc.)?
- (2) Is your company considered small under the NAICS code identified in this RFI?
- (3) Are you the manufacturer, authorized distributor, and/or can provide equivalent solution to the items being referenced above? If applicable, please provide the manufacturer name and business size.
- (4) Is the end product manufactured in the United States; and is the cost of the components made in the U.S. at least 55% of the total cost of components required to manufacture the end product? If the item is not manufactured in the U.S., please provide the country of origin.
- (5) If you are a large business, do you have any designated/authorized distributors? If so, please provide their company name, telephone, point of Contact and size status (if available).
- (6) If you're a small business and you are an authorized distributor/reseller for the items identified above or an equivalent solution, do you alter; assemble; modify; the items requested in any way? If you do, state how and what is altered; assembled; modified?
- (7) If you intend to subcontract any work on this contract, what portion of the total cost will be self-performed/will be performed by your organization? Please provide estimated detailed percentage breakdowns related to subcontracted work and completion of job.
- (8) Does your company have a Federal Supply Schedule (FSS) GSA/NAC/SAC/BPA/NASA SEWP or any other Federal Government contract? If so, please provide the contract number.

(9) If you are an FSS GSA/NAC/SAC/BPA/NASA SEWP or any other Federal Government contract holder, are all the items/solutions you are providing information for available on your schedule/contract? Please state if all or some items are available on the contract.

(10) General pricing of your products/solution is encouraged. Pricing will be used for the purpose of market research only and to determine if a set-aside can be made. It will not be used to evaluate for any type of award.

(11) Please submit your capabilities statement illustrating your organization's ability to meet the described salient characteristics or "equal to items" for planning purposes; show clear, compelling and convincing evidence that all "equal to items" meet all the salient characteristics.

(12) Please review salient characteristics/statement of work (if applicable) and provide feedback or suggestions. If none, please reply as N/A.

(13) Please provide your SAM.gov Unique Entity ID/Cage Code number.

NOTE: The information requested above is required for the Government to evaluate whether there are sufficient small business concerns of a particular type who are capable of performing the work required by this procurement to determine if this procurement should be set aside for a given type of small business concern. FAILURE TO SUBMIT ALL OF THE INFORMATION REQUESTED ABOVE TO SUPPORT A RESPONDENT'S CLAIMED EXPERIENCE MAY BE VIEWED BY THE GOVERNMENT AS EVIDENCE THAT THE RESPONDENT LACKS THE ABILITY TO PROVIDE THE CLINICAL SURVEILLANCE SOFTWARE AND SERVICES REQUIRED BY THIS PROCUREMENT. THIS, IN TURN, MAY AFFECT THE GOVERNMENT'S DETERMINATION ABOUT WHETHER THE REQUIREMENTS FOR A SET-ASIDE PROCUREMENT HAVE BEEN MET.

All responses to this Sources Sought/RFI will be used for planning purposes only. If a solicitation is issued as a result of the information provided from this RFI, all interested parties must respond to that solicitation separately in accordance with the specifications of that separate solicitation announcement. All Offerors who provide goods or services to the United States Government must be registered in the System for Award Management (SAM) database found at <https://www.sam.gov>. Registration must include Representations and Certifications.

Responses to this Sources Sought/RFI notice is not considered a request to be added to a prospective bidders list or to receive a copy of the solicitation.

REMINDER to include the following within subject line of your email submission:
RFI: 36C26226Q0599

--End of Sources Sought Announcement--